CSTACK · CLAYTON KIM · ONE PAGE

Cheat sheet

Turn expert judgment into evals, improve an agent against them, and remove complexity that no longer helps.

INSTALL

```
npx skills add theclaymethod/cstack \
  --skill expert-mode distill-me bootstrap create-eval run-eval cross-examine \
  hill-climb co-climb adversarial-cases calibrate-judge ablation bitter-lesson help tutor \
  -a codex -a claude-code -a cursor --copy
```

TYPICAL ORDER

1 · Capture

expert-mode while you work, or **distill-me** after the session. **bootstrap** when you know the behavior and have no useful traces yet.

2 · Author

create-eval turns reviewed evidence into cases and graders. **calibrate-judge** when a semantic judge must agree with authoritative labels.

3 · Measure

run-eval executes and keeps the receipt. **cross-examine** challenges the score. **adversarial-cases** builds the hard inputs and controls.

4 · Change

hill-climb improves against a fixed eval. **ablation** removes parts. **bitter-lesson** revisits old steering after a model change. Then measure again.

SKILL	REACH FOR IT WHEN
`expert-mode`	You are about to work and can say what is wrong, acceptable, or still uncertain.
`distill-me`	This session already contains judgments that are not saved as records.
`bootstrap`	You can describe the behavior and need the first reviewed scenarios before traces exist.
`create-eval`	Reviewed judgments or approved scenarios should become cases and graders.
`calibrate-judge`	A judge will score meaning, and you have authoritative labels to fit it against.
`run-eval`	Cases exist and you need a fresh execution receipt, not a remembered score.
`cross-examine`	A pass or fail may be crediting the wrong outcome or rejecting a legitimate one.
`adversarial-cases`	You need a small constructed challenge, fault, or control. Approval stays with the parent skill.
`hill-climb`	A fixed evaluator shows failures and you may edit only the authorized target.
`co-climb`	Failures may come from the judge. Alternate target improvements and judge calibration, keeping one fixed while changing the other.
`ablation`	The target meets the quality bar and you want to delete instructions, tools, or steps.
`bitter-lesson`	A model change may make inherited prompt or scaffolding unnecessary. Removal still has to clear the old bar.
`help`	You are unsure which skill fits. It reads the files you already have and names one next step.
`tutor`	You want to practice the pack. It teaches playground exercises 01–13, one question at a time.

INVOKE

Codex `$name` · **Claude Code and Cursor** `/name` · **Claude plugin** `/cstack:name`

```
python3 fixtures/playground/scripts/new_workspace.py \
--out eval-runs/playground
```

WHAT A RESULT IS

Untuned is the original target. **Synthetic** and **adversarial** cases are constructed. **True labeled data** is a human judgment on a real example, only inside the scope that was reviewed.